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ANI

FLOODS IN INDIAN STATE OF KERALA LEAVE 15 DEAD

Kerala intensified rescue and relief operations yesterday as the death toll from days of torrential rain and flooding rose to 15, even as authorities said the overall situation was gradually coming under control in most parts of the state despite forecasts of more heavy rain. More than 11,000 people have been shifted to relief camps across the state, while emergency teams remain on high alert as swollen rivers, the threat of landslides and rising water levels continue to pose risks in several districts. **SEE ALSO P11**

BUSINESS
Abu Dhabi accelerates megaprojects to boost tourism | P-11



ENTERTAINMENT

Vir Das on misogyny, viral crowd work and more | P12

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Dubai's new shared housing law comes into force soon

Ban on tenants from subleasing any part of a shared housing unit

DUBAI
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN
Chief Reporter

Dubai's new law regulating shared housing, which carries fines of up to Dh1 million for repeat violations, will come into force on August 26.

The confirmation of the date comes as landlords, tenants and operators prepare for one of the most sweeping shake-ups of the shared accommodation market.

The fact that the law bans tenants from subleasing any part of a shared housing unit is among its most significant changes for residents.

Only property owners, or companies authorised to manage or lease units on an owner's behalf, will be allowed to rent out shared accommodation.

Direct leasing by owner

Units can be leased directly by the owner, through a management company, or through a company that leases from the owner and subleases to

Violations under the law can draw fines ranging from Dh500 up to Dh500,000, doubling to Dh1 million for repeat offences within a year.

residents, but tenants themselves are excluded from that chain entirely.

Property owners and operators running shared housing have one year to bring their units into compliance.

Violations under the law can draw fines ranging from Dh500 up to Dh500,000, doubling to Dh1 million for repeat offences within a year. Additional penalties can include suspending activity for up to six months, cancelling permits, revoking commercial licences, disconnecting services, or ordering eviction from non-compliant units.

No shared housing unit can be designated as such without a new permit to be issued by Dubai Municipality in coordination with the Dubai Land Department.

SEE ALSO P2

Dubai retains crown as world's busiest airport

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

Dubai International Airport retained its position as the world's busiest airport for international seat capacity in August, with airlines scheduling 4.54 million one-way seats, or about 9 million seats across both directions, as carriers expanded operations to meet peak summer demand.

According to aviation data provider OAG, the airport recorded a 4.4 per cent increase in scheduled international seat capacity compared with July, adding around 190,000 seats month on month.

London Heathrow ranked second with 4.26 million scheduled international seats, followed by Seoul Incheon with 3.95 million. Amsterdam Schiphol placed fourth with 3.85 million seats, while Istanbul Airport completed the top five with 3.80 million.

TRUMP TELLS IRAN TO MAKE A DEAL OR SURRENDER

Tehran says it is currently not holding negotiations with the US

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

US President Donald Trump lashed out yesterday after Iran denied it was in negotiations with the United States, declaring in an angry social media post that a US military blockade will continue until there is a "Deal, or Total surrender."

Calling Iran "duplicious" for "openly and proudly" saying it was not negotiating, Trump wrote: "Whether Iran wants to admit it or not, we are, in fact, talking of a solution to a problem that they have caused, for decades."

Trump's statement on Truth Social came after Iran said there were no direct talks with Washington, as Trump had insisted there would be when he called off a threatened round of heavy bombing against Iran over the weekend, citing what he said were appeals from regional powers and Tehran.

The Iranian foreign ministry said yesterday that the only talks it was holding were with Oman to discuss plans for sharing control over the Strait of Hormuz, a vital passage for the global energy trade.

Trump insisted Iran had asked for talks — "some would say 'beg'" — but was now giving "their usual blather" about controlling Hormuz.

'Wall of Steel'

The strait, Trump insisted, "is already completely controlled by the United States Navy and our 'Blockade' or, as some say, 'The United States Wall of Steel!' Nothing gets through to Iran, unless we want it to, and nothing will get through, unless a Deal, or Total Surrender, is accomplished."

Trump launched a war, together with Israel, against Iran on February 28.

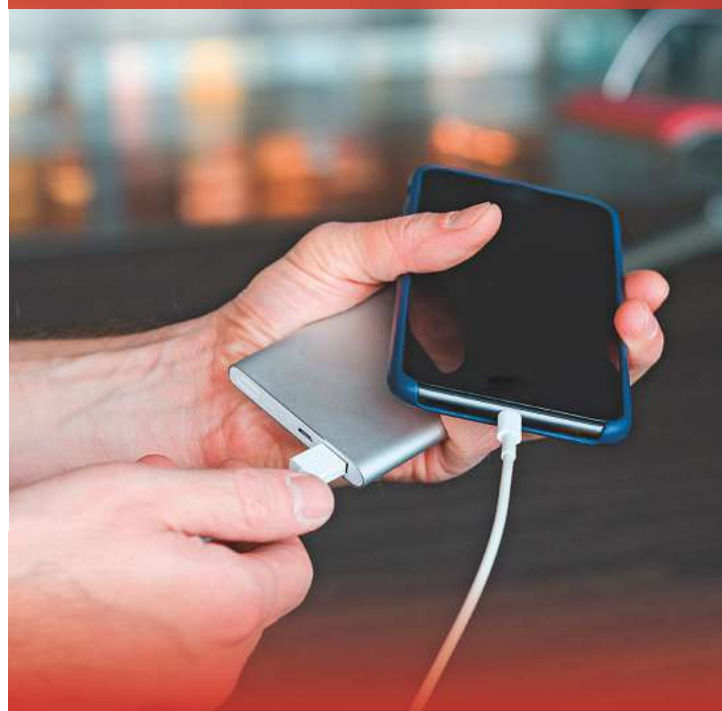
Original goals included destruction of the country's nuclear industry, missiles and backing for a popular uprising against the government.

More than five months later, Iran remains able to fire missiles and drones at US and allied targets in the region, and retains its enriched uranium stockpiles.

Despite the US pressure, Iranian attacks on ships in Hormuz have severely impacted global energy trading, giving Tehran a strong new card in the standoff.

SEE ALSO P6

IN FOCUS



THE RISKS OF FLYING WITH A POWER BANK

When the lithium-ion battery is damaged, poorly manufactured or handled incorrectly, it can overheat | P8-9